

The following is a faithful transcription of message by Father Solanus Casey written by hand, on the fly leaf of a volume of the Mystical City of God by Ven. Mary of Agreda (English translation, 1912):

The writings of Ven. Mother Mary of Agreda, of which these presents is an abridged edition, are so inspired-like and so inspiring, and it's praises and imprimaturs have been so outstanding and so persistent - including the highest authority in church and state - - that anyone with faith in divine authority (one would think) ought to hesitate to criticize it - as being above all criticism.

In fact it's bitterest enemies since it's first appearance have been in the janenestic and atheistic members of the Parisian Sarbonne, whose want of faith is beyond all doubt.

A REMINISCENCE

From earliest childhood I had regrettingly wondered why they had never written the life of the Blessed Virgin. I figured even at that time, when I heard them read from the lives of the saints: "If the life of a common saint is so Heaven-inspiring, what might we not hope for from the life of Mary the Queen of them all!" - - - But oh! how little I could realize at that time, the inopportunity of such a move; when even now it meets such indifference and so much opposition.

Then a renowned poet had referred to Mary Immaculate as "Humanity's Solatary Boast," and in another place:

"The liveness of all great remind us that we can make our lives sublime; and parting, leave behind us worthy food-prints on the sands of time."

Childhood days and decades Shortly after my ordination I was asked about the "Life of the Bl. Virgin" and was decidedly skeptical as to its ever having been written. However, I was determined to find it if it really existed.

. Glory be to God! We did find the abridgd copy of the Mystical City Thanks be to God. From that first per-perusal - - the conviction has grown on me - I have studied it since - 47 yr's - have prayed on my knees, the four vols and am convinced that it is the real autobiography - Life of the Bl. Virgin Mary Mother of God.

/s/ Fr. Solanus OFM. Cap.

Original autograph was written for Albert Wingert around 1950, and he died March 17, 1973.

Original is possession of:

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